

What you will learn...

We have two things to share with you. First, we want to give you a neat and simple guide to the OpenSolaris operating system. Second, through OpenSolaris, we want to show you how open source is not just about *using* open source software, but also contributing too. In a unique attempt, the Digit editorial team accepted contribution from members of the Mumbai OpenSolaris User Group for this *Fast Track to OpenSolaris*.

You can use this issue of Fast Track as a quick and dirty guide to OpenSolaris. It is not only for those who want to become open source developers, but also for those who're looking at options other than proprietary operating. Here's what to find:

Chapter 1: We introduce you to OpenSolaris by giving you a brief history and some of its features, along with what's different when compared to other popular operating systems.

Chapter 2: Here is discuss how to use the LiveCD and how to install OpenSolaris.

Chapter 3: In this chapter we tell you how to use OpenSolaris. How to install new applications and how to manage and update your system. We also describe how to troubleshoot your system and install device drivers. By end of this chapter you will be proficient in use of OpenSolaris.

Chapter 4: In this chapter we introduce one of the most distinct feature of OpenSolaris in detail, which is ZFS filesystem. This chapter will take you under the hood and explain you things in deeper detail than what an average user is expected to know.

If you're afraid of running commands on the terminal thinking something may go wrong then do not worry. After you finish installing OpenSolaris, just open a terminal and execute the command `$ pfexec beadm create backup-boot`. This will create a new boot environment for OpenSolaris and if you do manage to make something go wrong somehow, you can select this from the boot menu and unless you have done something very nasty with your hardware, your system should boot up as usual.